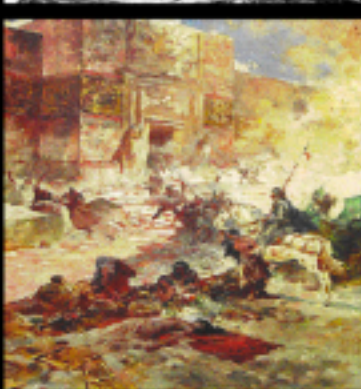




As a Result

- Guns, germs and steel
- Following the Spanish conquest;
 - Incan cities were destroyed
 - Spanish cities built on top
 - Incan people were displaced
 - Spanish culture/religion forced upon them
 - Gold, gems, and silver taken from Incan and other indigenous people
 - Indigenous peoples to work in mines



This “large-scale depopulation” resulted in vast tracts of agricultural land being left untended, researchers say, allowing the land to become overgrown with trees and other new vegetation.

The regrowth soaked up enough carbon dioxide from the atmosphere to actually cool the planet, with the average temperature dropping by 0.15C in the late 1500s and early 1600s, [the study by scientists at University College London found.](#)